was coach, and Anil Kumble had joined us as mentor, making it a very strong support unit.

I started the season with a disappointing run-out but batted well from the middle of the tournament. Ricky, however, was not in the best of form and he decided to drop himself for a few games and hand the captaincy to Rohit, who was batting well. Rohit did a very good job as skipper and the bowling too came together nicely, with Malinga, Mitchell Johnson, Harbhajan and Pragyan Ojha consistently doing well for us. But just when my own form was peaking, I sustained the injury that brought my IPL career to an end.

We were playing the Sunrisers Hyderabad on 13 May 2013 and were in control, having scored 91 off twelve overs, with the loss of just one wicket. The asking rate was slightly over ten runs an over and with nine wickets in hand we had every reason to feel confident. I was starting to accelerate and hit the first ball of the thirteenth over for six over long on. Just as I was completing the shot, I heard a click in my left hand and then felt excruciating pain. I immediately called for the physio, but massage didn't do any good. I was finding it impossible to hold the bat, let alone play a shot. It was a critical time in the match and there was no way I could keep playing on and waste balls in the process. The only option was to retire hurt.

I had a series of scans, which showed inflammation of the tendons and fluid accumulation in the hand. The doctors said it would take a minimum of three weeks to heal and it was clear my campaign was over. Though I wasn't able to play, I decided to travel with the team. I bowled long stints in the nets and did what I could to help the boys with their preparation. It was hard to sit out for the final, though, particularly because I was getting into a good rhythm, but it was an incredible feeling when the Mumbai Indians won the 2013 IPL trophy in front of a packed Eden Gardens crowd in Kolkata. To cap it all, my team-mates very kindly said that the triumph was for me.

It was during the final that I was asked in an interview if I would play the first game of the next IPL season in front of my home crowd at the Wankhede. It was clear to me that I would not be able to and I found myself saying so. I hadn't actually planned to announce my retirement from the IPL and it happened on the spur of the moment. Anjali was at the ground and a number of journalists went on to ask her what she thought of me announcing my retirement from the IPL. She was a little